1929. A page of the judgment sentencing Kartar Singh Sarabha to death, which bears some hand-written notes by Bhagat Singh, is on display at the Shaheed-e-Azam Bhagat Singh Museum in Katkar Kalyan.

After all, Kartar Singh Sarabha was one of Bhagat Singh's childhood heroes. In 1912, he left Ludhiana in Punjab for San Francisco. Entering Berkeley University as an engineering student, he founded the Ghadar Party. This was an international political movement established in the United States on 15 July 1913. It was initially called the Pacific Coast Hindustan Association, and it was formed with the express aim of overthrowing British rule in India, under the leadership of Har Dayal along with other Indians there. When the First World War broke out, the Ghadar Party too declared its *Ailan-i-Jang* on Britain in the form of a declaration of war, following which Sarabha hastened to return to India. Upon arrival he was unfortunately betrayed by an accomplice in 1915, just as Bhagat Singh was in his time by his own comrades. Upon being captured, he was put not before a regular court for trial, but before a specially convened tribunal, just as Bhagat Singh was to be just over a decade later. It was a special tribunal that sentenced Sarabha to death in what came to be known as the First Lahore Conspiracy Case.[1] It was also of course a special tribunal which sentenced Bhagat Singh to death in what came to be known as the Second Lahore Conspiracy Case 1931. Barely an adult at 19, Sarabha was also charged with the same offence of conspiracy against the King as Bhagat Singh. The First World War was ongoing during Kartar Singh Sarabha's hanging. Tensions were high. His death in November 1915 was essential to the Raj.

Yet, death in revolution was not just a matter for the executioner. It was also a matter of importance for the executed. It was his prerogative no less. This is best epitomized in the words of Ram Prasad Bismil, a revolutionary poet who took part in the Mainpuri Conspiracy 1918 and the Kakori Conspiracy 1925. He was hanged on 19 December 1927. Popularly known as 'Bismil' and associated with the Arya Samaj, he wrote the poem, '*sarfaroshi ki tamanna ab hamare dil meñ hai*'[2] (meaning, 'The desire for revolution is in our hearts'), where the word '*sarfaroshi*' quite literally